



Cambridge International Examinations
Cambridge International General Certificate of Secondary Education

FIRST LANGUAGE ENGLISH

0500/33

Paper 3 Directed Writing and Composition

October/November 2016

READING BOOKLET INSERT

2 hours

READ THESE INSTRUCTIONS FIRST

This Reading Booklet Insert contains the reading passage for use with **Section 1, Question 1** on the Question Paper.

You may annotate this Insert and use the blank spaces for planning. This Insert is **not** assessed by the Examiner.

This document consists of **3** printed pages and **1** blank page.



Read the passage carefully, and then answer **Section 1, Question 1** on the Question Paper.

In this magazine article, the writer has agreed to take part in a TV reality series named 'Workplace Choirs'. This TV series follows the experiences of all the staff in an organisation who learn to sing together under the guidance of professional musicians. Viewers vote for their favourite choir.

Workplace Choirs

'Anyone can join,' reads the recruitment poster in the office canteen. 'No experience required, just come along.' That isn't entirely correct. There are 'Auditions'. Does that mean I have to sing in front of people? My plan in agreeing to be a choir member at all involved lurking anonymously in the back row.

We're all under pressure to audition – no excuses accepted. Afterwards, we'll be told who's made it and who hasn't. Those selected will then be rehearsed mercilessly and sent to battle with choirs from other workplaces to see which one triumphs. The 'highs and lows' will be broadcast live to the nation as we go – yes, the whole thing will be televised!

This is now series six of the show worldwide, so it seems workplace choirs are here to stay. People apparently enjoy singing in groups and the health benefits are indisputable. With big business in on the act though, aren't these choirs really just free advertising for their companies?

That's not what the promotional video we watch before auditions claims. Hilary Queen, head of retail giant Canco which won the last series, explains: 'Choirs are popping up everywhere, in schools and hospitals too. Modern managers understand they rely on teamwork. Choirs need people to do different things together, without losing focus. Choirs develop a workforce's confidence and resilience.'

I'll need resilience to stand the shame of revealing my dulcet tones in front of Abi-from-Accounts. Her target is the solo spot. She's been practising loudly at the water-cooler for weeks.

Having auditions seems a bit much if you're trying to encourage people to sing. A choir isn't a sports team, is it? I don't mind admitting I'm rubbish at football, but I'll feel rejected if my bathroom baritone turns out to make everyone's toes curl. It's personal when someone says you can't sing.

'It's great seeing people's faces when you say they're in,' chirps the choirmaster. 'It really boosts their confidence being part of the team.' He's genuinely enthusiastic, but missing my point.

For those who are 'in' there'll be endless hours of rehearsing, shift-swopping to be there, bickering when no-one can agree which song to sing or who gets the best bits. There may be no 'I' in 'team': there is, it seems, in 'choir'.

'I love singing. Being on TV's a great opportunity. I couldn't believe I'd been selected to sing the opening solo on a world-famous stage,' gushes series-one-finalist Carie. 'It's the breakthrough I needed to get into the music industry. I'm not in insurance anymore.'

What if we all sound awful though, and people don't turn up for rehearsals?

'Sticking at it when things aren't working out is something I teach my staff. Every workforce needs discipline,' scolds Queen in the video. 'Employers also need to commit time and resources, by providing spaces for rehearsal, and being flexible with rotas.'

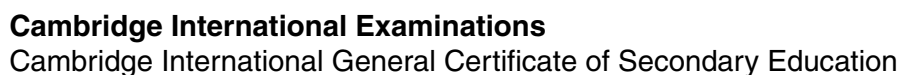
But is it necessary to be on TV while you're struggling to learn the music? Aren't producers going to smell any whiff of drama, behind-the-scenes sob stories, frictions? What's a workplace choir supposed to be for anyway? The motivational video describes harmonious days spent bonding, laughing and singing together. I find myself drawn, moth-like. My company needs me. I'm determined not to let them down, though my football coach might be less impressed when I miss practices at weekends for rehearsals.

‘It’s been a journey,’ reflects tenor Dan in the next clip of the video, his long-suffering family in the background. ‘From initial terror to a sense of achievement when you hear the applause – I didn’t think I had it in me. I can’t imagine my life without the choir.’

Unsurprisingly, small-business-owner Bob, doesn’t feature in the promotional footage. ‘I can’t afford time off for my employees to have a sing-along,’ he grumbles. ‘They should sort out their own hobbies.’

Overwhelmed with the demands of running their businesses, many other employers claim neither the time nor resources for workplace choirs. Some bosses worry they’ll be misrepresented by TV producers, keen to catch conflict on camera. Meanwhile, producers defend the series. ‘In many workplaces staff at different levels of the workforce rarely meet, whereas in a choir they all need to work together. That difference makes for interesting viewing.’

‘I got to know colleagues I’d never even spoken to,’ Dan continues. ‘We had a list of all the choir members. There were loads of emails going back and forth every day. Sometimes it was hard to get any work done!’



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No Additional Materials are required.

DO NOT WRITE IN ANY BARCODES.

Dictionaries are **not** permitted.

The Reading Booklet Insert contains the reading passage for use with **Question 1, Section 1** on this Question Paper. The Insert is **not** assessed by the Examiner.

The number of marks is given in brackets [] at the end of each question or part question.

This document consists of **11** printed pages, **1** blank page and **1** Reading Booklet Insert.

Read carefully the magazine article about 'Workplace Choirs' in the Reading Booklet Insert and then answer **Section 1, Question 1** on this Question Paper.

Section 1: Directed Writing

Question 1

Imagine you work for a traditional, family-run business. The owner, Mr Hsu, is keen on taking part in the next series of 'Workplace Choirs'. Not all of the 45 staff are happy about the idea.

Mr Hsu has asked you to give your honest opinion on whether the business should take part or not.

Write a letter offering your opinion and advice.

In your letter you should:

- evaluate the benefits **and** problems for the business if it takes part
- explain the concerns staff may have about taking part **and** how these concerns may be overcome.

Base your letter on what you have read in the article, but be careful to use your own words. Address both of the bullet points.

Begin your letter,
'Dear Mr Hsu,
Taking part in this TV show could be...'.
'

Write about 250 to 350 words.

Up to 10 marks are available for the content of your answer, and up to 15 marks for the quality of your writing.

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[Total: 25]

Section 2: Composition**Questions 2, 3, 4 and 5**

Write about 350 to 450 words on **one** of the following questions. Answer on this Question Paper.

Up to 13 marks are available for the content and structure of your answer, and up to 12 marks for the style and accuracy of your writing.

Descriptive Writing

- 2** Imagine you are just about to face a major challenge. Describe your thoughts and feelings as you begin.

OR

- 3** Describe the atmosphere and your thoughts and feelings at the end of a final performance.

OR

Narrative Writing

- 4** Write a story that begins, 'The figure moved swiftly and noiselessly, as if not wanting to be observed...'.

OR

- 5** Write a story which involves someone losing their way.

Please write your chosen question number here: **2, 3, 4** or **5**:

This image shows a full page of a worksheet designed for handwriting practice. It consists of approximately 20 horizontal rows. Each row is defined by two parallel dashed lines, creating a series of uniform gaps for letter height. The lines are evenly spaced across the entire page, providing a guide for consistent letter formation. There is no text or other markings on the page.

[Total: 25]

[illegible]

This image shows a full page of a handwriting practice worksheet. It consists of multiple sets of three horizontal dashed lines, providing a guide for letter height and placement. The lines are evenly spaced across the entire page, leaving ample room for writing practice. There is no text or other markings on the page.